The final decision results from the combined impact of all evaluated policies.

To make this description more concrete, table 6.3 presents an attribute evaluation matrix for ACME Corp's deployment system. It shows how various combinations of attributes—such as clearance level, device status, time of day, and on-call status—might impact the outcome of a deployment access request.

Table 6.3 Attribute evaluation matrix for ABAC-based deployment access at ACME Corp

Scenario	clearance_level	device_managed	hour_of_day	on_call	Decision
Alice deploying at 10 pm, on call	high	true	22	true	Allow
Alice deploying at 10 pm, not on call	high	true	22	false	Deny
Bob deploying at 2 pm	medium	true	14	false	Deny
Carol deploying at 2 pm	high	true	14	false	Deny
Alice deploying at 10 am on a managed device	high	true	10	false	Allow

This matrix captures the layered logic of ACME's ABAC policy: all requests must originate from a managed device; during business hours, engineers with high clearance are permitted; outside business hours, the requester must also be on call. Although simplified for illustration, this pattern demonstrates how ABAC enables access to be both flexible and precise, adapting to context while remaining grounded in clear policy logic. This makes ABAC ideal for organizations with decentralized teams and diverse systems: each team or application can define policies suited to their needs while still conforming to broader organizational standards.

6.2.2 Mapping ABAC onto the authorization reference architecture

ABAC maps naturally onto the authorization reference architecture described in chapter 4. The Policy Enforcement Point (PEP) is typically